

San Diego Space Institute (SDSI)

PRESS RELEASE

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

November 21, 2025

San Diego Space Institute Joins UC San Diego's Space Day Forum to Advance Regional Collaboration

SAN DIEGO – The San Diego Space Institute (SDSI) announced today that President Dr. Sean Casey, Ph.D., MBA and Board Director Dave Strobel attended UC San Diego's Space Day Forum on November 20, 2025. The event brought together leaders from academia, industry, and government to support California's rapidly expanding space economy.

SDSI's participation centered on targeted networking with speakers and attendees. Dr. Casey and Mr. Strobel held focused discussions with representatives from DARPA, SpaceWERX, Vi-asat, New Vista Capital, ReflecTek, and multiple UC San Diego interdisciplinary teams. Conversations explored new partnerships in space-weather science, workforce development, and small-satellite programs that align with SDSI's mission.

A key highlight was SDSI's promotion of Sentinel-Bio+ (SB+), its student-led CubeSat mission and flagship grassroots initiative supported by the NASA California Space Grant. Designed and built by students from SDSU, SJSU, and partner institutions, SB+ gives the next generation hands-on experience in end-to-end mission development while delivering valuable radiation and atmospheric-drag data for NASA and NOAA.

SB+ Mission Objectives

- Train California's future aerospace and AI workforce through NASA-style SRR → PDR → CDR milestones.
- Establish SDSI as a regional hub for student-driven space-weather missions.
- Provide a scalable platform for future LEO, VLEO, and heliophysics sensor payloads.

SDSI also introduced its new Founders Circle, an exclusive group of seven early supporters funding the 2026 SB+ engineering prototype. Each member contributes \$15,000 toward a \$105,000 goal, effectively doubling NASA Space Grant support. Founders receive permanent recognition at the Fleet Science Center exhibit, in mission documentation, and across all SDSI platforms.

"California's space sector is accelerating rapidly, and UC San Diego sits at its heart," said Dr. Sean Casey, President of SDSI. "We're making sure San Diego's students, researchers, and communities don't just watch the new space economy—they help build it."

"SB+ proves that a grassroots student program can evolve into a genuine scientific and educational asset for the entire state," added Dave Strobel. "Events like UC San Diego's Space Day are where the relationships are forged to make that happen."

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